Winter Fuel Payment 2026 Key Dates

From the qualifying week to the 31 March 2027 claim deadline

1. **Mon., Sept. 21 to Sun., Sept. 27, 2026** ☐
   Qualifying week: your birth date and circumstances this week set the amount
2. **Mon., Oct. 19, 2026** ☐
   Claims by phone open
3. **Oct. to Nov. 2026** ☐
   Letter with the amount for those who get one
4. **Nov. to Dec. 2026** ☐
   Most eligible people are paid (exact dates not published)
5. **Mon., Dec. 21, 2026** ☐
   Opting out for 2027 to 2028 becomes possible
6. **Jan. 2027** ☐
   Tax code changes to start collecting the 2026 payment if income is over £35,000
7. **Mar. 31, 2027** ☐
   Wednesday: deadline to claim for winter 2026 to 2027

My notes

Source: GOV.UK Winter Fuel Payment pages; mygov.scot; nidirect. Exact payment dates are not published.